COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

GINGIVAL RETRACTION CORD
(Impregnated with Aluminum Sulfate)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

Salient characteristics:

This commercial item description covers impregnated gingival retraction cords suitable for use in gingival retraction during dental procedures.

The gingival retraction cords shall be of the following types, as specified below:

Type I - 3 Ply Cord
Type II - 4 Ply Cord
Type III - 5 Ply Cord

Description: The retraction cord shall be a multi-plied cord, spun from bleached, virgin, 100% long staple cotton, impregnated with a 10% aqueous solution of pharmaceutical grade aluminum sulfate. Yarn characteristics of the retraction cord shall be as shown in Table I below:

Table I - Yarn characteristics

Type	Strand Diameter	Cord Diameter	Weight of 25 yards of untreated cord
I	0.008 inch ± 0.001 inch	0.019 inch ± 0.002 inch	2.50 grams ± 0.35 grams
II	0.011 inch ± 0.001 inch	0.026 inch ± 0.002 inch	4.00 grams ± 0.50 grams
III	0.018 inch ± 0.002 inch	0.042 inch ± 0.004 inch	6.75 grams ± 0.85 grams

Type I cord shall be formed by twisting three strands or single ply yarn 156 ± 10 turns per foot in a direction opposite to the twist of each single strand.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The finished cord shall have a soft, expandable texture with a mercerized finish.

Type II cord shall be formed by twisting four strands of single ply yarn 92 ± 6 turns per foot in a direction opposite to the twist of each single strand. The finished cord shall have a soft, expandable texture with a mercerized finish.

Type III cord shall be formed by twisting five strands of single ply yarn 48 ± 3 turns per foot in a direction opposite to the twist of each single strand. The finished cord shall have a soft, expandable texture without a starch or polish finish.

The retraction cords shall be impregnated with the aluminum sulfate solution using a vacuum or roller press process, and then the cord shall be thoroughly dehydrated in a drying chamber.

The retraction cords shall be light green in color and shall have a minimum length of 72 inches.

Finished cord characteristics shall be as shown in Table II below:

Table II. Finished cord characteristics

Type	Aluminum sulfate content	Breaking strength
I	0.35 to 0.60 milligram per inch of cord	3.0 pounds, minimum
II	0.70 to 1.00 milligram per inch of cord	3.3 pounds, minimum
III	1.20 to 1.70 milligram per inch of cord	6.0 pounds, minimum

Breaking strength testing shall be in accordance with ASTM Standard D2256. The assay for aluminum sulfate shall be by a suitable spectrophotometric or other analytical procedure.

Immediate container. The immediate container for the retraction cord shall be a plastic dispenser having a suitable closure to prevent contamination or deterioration of the cord. The dispenser-tip cap shall provide a tangle-free cord. The immediate container shall not interact physically or chemically with the retraction cords.

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Instructions for use. Adequate and accurate instructions for the use of the retraction cords shall accompany each unit package.

Shelf life. The shelf life of the retraction cord shall be not less than 36 months from date of manufacture.

Delivery schedule. Not more than 3 months shall have elapsed from the date of manufacture of the retraction cords to the date of delivery to the Government.

Workmanship. Gingival retraction cords shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability. The immediate containers shall be free from all dirt, foreign matter, and other contaminants, both before and after filling.

Unit. Bottle (BT). One bottle containing not less than 72 inches of cord, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Unit package. The bottle of retraction cord and instructions for use shall be packaged in a suitable box. The bottle and box shall be marked with the lot or control number and the expiration date.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the used of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one bottle of retraction cord. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level II, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level S-1.

Examination. The retraction cord shall be examined for defects including, but not limited to, those listed below.

Defects.

Type of cord not as specified.
Color of cord not light green as specified.
Texture of cord not as specified.
Length of cord not as specified.
Cord has other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.
Immediate container not proper type.
Lot number and expiration date not marked on immediate container.
Immediate containers not clean.
Instructions for use missing, incomplete or illegible.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pounds units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and of regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document.

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation
6520-01-055-0016	GINGIVAL RETRACTION CORD, IMPREGNATED, Dental, 3 ply	Type I
6520-01-055-0017	GINGIVAL RETRACTION CORD, IMPREGNATED, Dental, 5 ply	Type III
6520-01-119-7701	GINGIVAL RETRACTION CORD, IMPREGNATED, Dental, 4 ply	Type II

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

08904

PROJECT NO. 6520-2313
LOCATION: NCR - DISK 8

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53995	GINGIVAL RETRACTION CORD (Impregnated with Aluminum Sulfate)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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